25 August 1971
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-4232C
9 February 1968

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CORD, RAYON, WITHOUT CORE, BRAIDED

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.- This specification covers braided rayon cord (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.- The cord shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.2):

Type I	- 400 pounds minimum breaking strength.
Type II	- 1000 pounds minimum breaking strength.
Type III	- 1500 pounds minimum breaking strength.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

UU-T-81 - Tags, Shipping and Stock.

MILITARY

MIL-C-3131 - Cordage; Preparation for Delivery of.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-191 - Textile, Test Methods

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

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(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Government and supplier purchases.- The requirements specified in 3.5 and 3.6 apply only to cord purchased directly by the Government. All other requirements apply to cord purchased by a supplier as a component for an end item and to cord purchased directly by the Government.

3.2 Material.- The yarn used in the fabrication of the cord shall be high tenacity viscose rayon 3.0 to 4.6 grams per denier. The denier of each basic yarn shall be 1100 minimum. No chemical finishes or treatments shall be applied to specifically increase the weight or breaking strength.

* 3.3 Construction and physical requirements.- The braided cord shall conform to the construction and physical requirements specified in table I when tested as specified in 4.2.5. The cord shall be braided on braiding machines having the number of carriers (strands) specified in table I, and the machines shall be so regulated as to give a two over and two under conventional stitch i.e. each carrier alternating with the next carrier in direction and each strand passes alternately over and under two of the opposite strands (see 4.2.1).

* 3.3.1 In the manufacture of the cord, no more than one carrier shall be allowed to be run off per 50 feet of cord. When carrier ends run off they shall be spliced a distance of 10 inches ± 1 inch in length. The approximate center of each splice shall be marked by inserting a red thread (of another fiber type) through the braid. The free ends of the marker shall extend approximately three inches on either side of the cord. Removal of the marker shall be accomplished by a light pull on either end. The marker shall not be removed until such time as the cord is to be used in the manufacture of parachute suspension lines or other applications (see 4.2.1 and 6.1).

TABLE I.- Construction and physical requirements

Characteristic	Type I	Type II	Type III
Yarn ply	1	1	1
Picks per inch:			
Minimum	9	5	3-1/2
Maximum	10	5-1/2	4
Number of carriers	16	16	16
Length per pound, feet (minimum)	126	60	39

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TABLE I.- Construction and physical requirements (cont'd)

Characteristic	Type I	Type II	Type III
Breaking strength, pounds (minimum)	400	1000	1500
Elongation, percent (minimum)	14	12	--

3.4 Color.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the cord shall be furnished in natural color or tinted methyl orange.

3.5 Put-up.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the cord shall be furnished in 525-yard spools (reels) and shall be wound so that each turn and layer is free from entanglement. Each spool (reel) shall contain not more than three pieces and no piece shall be less than 5 yards in length. A plus tolerance of 10 percent shall be allowed on the length of spool (reel) specified. The ends of all cord shall be taped, served or otherwise secured to prevent fraying. There shall be no knot, splice or otherwise joining of cord ends to form a continuous length of cord.

* 3.6 Identification.- Each spool (reel) of cord shall have a ticket (identification tag) or label attached to it for identification purposes. The ticket shall conform to the requirements for type B, class 1, size 4 or 5 of UU-T-81. The ticket shall be made of not less than 15 point paper stock and shall have a minimum tearing resistance of both directions (total) of 850 grams when tested as specified in UU-T-81. When labels are used, the label shall be attached in such a manner as to remain in place and be clearly legible until all cord has been removed. All ticket or label entries shall be legibly printed, stamped, or typed with water insoluble ink. The ticket or label shall contain the following information:

Stock number
Nomenclature
Specification number
Length and type
Contract number and date
Date of manufacture (month and year)
Supplier's name

3.7 Workmanship.- The braided cord shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance.- Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Inspection.- Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection.- In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in the specification or applicable purchase documents. In addition, inspection shall be performed for the requirements in table II and a supplier's certificate of compliance thereto shall be furnished and will be accepted for the requirement. The supplier shall also certify that the provisions cited in 3.3 and 3.3.1 have been adhered to in the manufacture of the cord.

TABLE II.- Component tests

Characteristic	Requirement reference
Material	3.2
Yarn denier	3.2
Tenacity	3.2
Chemical finishes	3.2
Yarn ply	Table I

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4.2.2 Examination of the end item for visual defects.- The defects listed in table III shall be counted regardless of their proximity to each other. The sample unit shall be one spool (reel). The lot size shall be expressed in units of one spool (reel) each. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 major defects per 100 units and the inspection level shall be level III. Any critical defect found during sampling inspection for major defects shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented by the sample.

TABLE III.- Visual examination

Examine	Defects	Classification Critical	Classification Major
Appearance and workmanship	Any cut.	X	
	Abrasion mark, chafed, or distortion in orientation of yarn	X	
	Kink or knot.	X	
	Unevenly braided resulting in open place, break in continuity of braid or soft spot.	X	
	More than one carrier run-off per 50 feet of cord.	X	
	Float, broken, projecting or loose strand or end. 1/	X	
Color	Not as specified.		X
Cleanness	Spot or stain, clearly noticeable. 2/		X
Identification label or ticket	Omitted, incorrect, illegible or not as specified.		X

1/ Splice marker thread not applicable.

2/ At normal inspection distance (approximately 3 feet).

4.2.3 Examination for length and winding.- The sample unit for this examination shall be one spool (reel). The inspection level shall be level S-3 and the AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective. The lot size shall be the number of spools (reels) in the lot. Defects with regard to length and winding shall be considered to exist if any of the following are determined during inspection:

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a. The length is less than specified or more than 10 percent in excess of the length specified.

b. Length is less than marked on ticket or label.

c. Improperly or not firmly wound, resulting in kinking, knotting, entangling or slippage during unwinding or otherwise affecting free unhampered unwinding of cord.

d. Put-up not as specified, i.e., not spools (reels).

e. Any end not taped or served.

f. Any spool (reel) containing more than 3 pieces.

g. Any piece less than 5 yards in length.

h. Knot, splice or otherwise joining of cord ends to make a continuous length of cord.

4.2.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.- An examination shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking complies with the section 5 requirements. The examination shall be in accordance with the provisions of MIL-C-3131, except that the inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

4.2.5 Testing of the end item.- The methods of testing specified in FED-STD-191, wherever applicable, and as listed in table V shall be followed. The physical and chemical values specified in Section 3 apply to the average of the determinations made on a sample unit for test purposes as specified in the applicable test methods. The sample size and acceptance and rejection numbers shall be in accordance with table IV. All test reports shall contain the individual values utilized in expressing the final result. The sample unit for testing shall be one spool (reel) of cord. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one spool (reel). All physical tests shall be performed under Standard Testing Conditions as defined in FED-STD-191.

TABLE IV.- Sampling for tests

No. of units in lot	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

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TABLE V.- Test methods

Characteristic	Requirement reference	Test method	Number of deter. per indiv. sample unit	Results reported as
Picks per inch	Table I	4.2.5.1	1	Pass or fail
Number of carriers	Table I	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Length per pound	Table I	6004	-	-
Breaking strength	Table I	6016	-	-
Elongation	Table I	6016	-	-

* 4.2.5.1 Determination of picks per inch.- Picks per inch shall be counted visually with the cord in a relaxed state without tension and so positioned that the repeat of the stitch pattern creates a straight line parallel to the axis of the cord.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.- Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A and C.- The cord, put up on spools (reels) as specified in 3.5, shall be packaged in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-C-3131.

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Levels A, B and C.- The cord shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-C-3131.

5.3 Marking.- In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-C-3131.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- The cord is intended for use as suspension lines of cargo parachutes and in other aerial delivery applications.

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6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type required (see 1.2).
(c) Color if other than natural or tinted methyl orange (see 3.4).
(d) Put-up if other than specified (see 3.5).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and suppliers are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Air Force - 11

Review activities:

Army - AV
Air Force - 45, 82
DSA-IS

User activities:

Army - ME
Navy - MC

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 4020-0190

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION
Cord, Rayon, Without Core, Braided MIL-C-4232D

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?
   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

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REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED.

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